

serve.

Get everyone to applaud.

DESSERT:

Do payday, and have the kids explain to your guests how payday works.

Then, everyone pitches in and does the dishes.

Now you're cooking!

Congratulations.

For all the thousands of monotonous meals you've had as a family, this evening will burn brightly in your memory, and your kids' memories.

(That's why you want to get plenty of pictures, because years from now you'll look back on this night and smile.)

Yes, there's something satisfying in teaching your kids an important life skill.

However, the parents who have done the Grandparents' Dinner Party tell me it's also a night when they feel connected as a family, and as your kids get older and more independent that's something you should celebrate.

What's more, you'll have taught your teen a lasting lesson about the true cost of eating out (or ordering in) . . . and the power of being able to whip up a tasty, nutritious meal on the cheap.

The more your kids cook, the better they'll get, so they should practise their newfound culinary skills by feeding the family at least once a month!

Next Money Meal we're going to switch gears. If you've got a bratty kid, or you're at risk of having one, I'm going to show you exactly what to do to 'break the brat'!